approval has given way to a growing sense of disappointment with how Lula and PT manage the challenges of governing Brazil (Hochstetler 2008; Rolnik 2011).

In this situation, the hosting of 'world-class' sports events draws in many people and increase their political engagement. In Brazil, the popular culture around sports (soccer) and festivals (carnival) has always been linked to politics or possible political abuse (DaMatta 1991; Wisnik 2006). People react with contempt at corrupt politicians who usually exploit public investments in the events for private gain.

In the process of political and urban change that has accompanied the construction of Rio de Janeiro as an Olympic city, it has been turned into a space for business, and no longer a space for political and democratic debate. Massive investments have been made over a short period, and ad hoc decisions have prevailed in order to develop binding plans. The prospect of the benefits that will come with hosting international mega-events has legitimised this depoliticisation of host cities. Basic democratic rights are put on hold, and the demands and rights of ordinary citizens are suppressed. These transformations have catalysed growing politicisation and social mobilisation in host cities and created an arena of conflict between actors associated with the state, the market and civil society.

As a response to the last decade's transformation in urban governance, millions of Brazilians took to the streets in June 2013 in what became the largest street demonstrations in recent history. What started as a protest against a price hike in public transportation in São Paulo quickly escalated to mass mobilisations against the massive public spending on stadiums and infrastructure related to the mega-events while the quality of public services remains precarious. They also revolted against the violence used by the police force to quell the demonstrations (Maricato 2013).

The June demonstrations raised issues in the public debate in Brazil regarding citizenship – how to listen to the 'voice of the street', take grievances of ordinary people seriously, and improve the quality of democracy. These manifestations did not come from nowhere: they represent the culmination of years in which a new generation of urban movements has formed. Organisations such as the Movimento Passe Livre ('movement for free transport'), student movements, urban resistance movements, favela residents' associations and the homeless workers' movement Sem Teto (those without a 'roof'/house) have, through occupations and demonstrations, issued in broader networks challenging the existing emptied-out, top-down spaces of participation. This new generation of urban movements and civic networks anticipates an 'insurgent citizenship'